Luis P. Salas

Data Governance Consultant / **AI Enablement** / **Metadata Strategy**

Making enterprise data AI-ready.

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§ 01 · PROFILE

FOCUS
GOVERNANCE · QUALITY · OBSERVABILITY · METADATA

STACK
ALATION · SNOWFLAKE · UNITY CATALOG · CORTEX · CREWAI

§ 02 · PROJECTS

PUBLIC WORK
TOOLKITS · LABS · WIKI · CASEBOOK

Summary

Multidisciplinary Data Governance & AI Enablement Consultant with **3+ years** delivering scalable solutions across Data Quality, Observability, Data Validation, and Metadata Management. Builds the governance infrastructure, data classification frameworks, and policy enforcement systems that make multi-platform, AI-driven data environments actually work.

Known for strong analytical thinking, disciplined documentation, and the ability to align technical execution with business value. Experienced working with executives, SMEs, engineering teams, and cross-functional stakeholders to advance governance maturity. Has completed AI governance coursework (Saïd Business School, Oxford).

Selected Projects

Governed Data Platform — Databricks Unity Catalog github.com/luispsalas/governed-data-platform
Built and verified a governed data platform: two-catalog prod/dev separation, a governed-tag classification taxonomy applied to every column across four layers, a group-based privilege matrix including the platform defaults most designs omit, tag-driven column masks and row-level filters, and a bronze → silver → gold pipeline with automatic lineage. Every control tested per persona against a second identity, which surfaced defects invisible to owner-run checks, including a mask that denied a column rather than masking it. Extended with structural anonymization (k-anonymity enforced by a constraint), a 20-control fault-seeded state-assertion suite, SOC 2 control mapping, and a Unity Catalog ↔ Snowflake governance crosswalk. Implementation guide, runbook and SQL published.

AI Enablement Toolkit github.com/luispsalas/ai-enablement-toolkit
Practical tools for adopting AI, from first pilot to proven value: adoption reviews, AI literacy, governance templates and use-case assessment, each usable on its own.

Applied AI Concepts — AI literacy wiki luispsalas.github.io/applied-ai-concepts
A maintained AI literacy resource of 156 concepts behind designing, deploying, and governing AI systems, with plain-language search.

Local Governance Knowledge Base luispsalas.github.io/portfolio/local-kb
A local, deterministic pipeline that builds and maintains a governance knowledge base.

Governed Workflow Automation luispsalas.github.io/portfolio/workflow-automation
Adding AI to a business workflow without leaking personal data: a privacy gate, rule-based approval and tested failure paths, built in n8n.

AI Observability Toolkit github.com/luispsalas/ai-observability-toolkit
Metrics and observability for AI systems, worked through real use cases: what to watch, how to read it, and how to improve results that have no exact grade. Starts with a NIST AI RMF crosswalk of 42 metrics.

Autonomous AI Casebook github.com/luispsalas/autonomous-ai-casebook
In-depth reconstructions of incidents where an AI system's autonomy was central to real-world security harm, built from primary sources.

§ 03 · PRACTICE

SCALE

350+ TABLES · 1,000+ COLUMNS · 85 DASHBOARDS

REACH

200+ CATALOG USERS · 80 CURATORS · 50 OWNERS

DOMAINS

SALES · SUPPLY CHAIN · COMMERCIAL · MARKETING · DG · WAREHOUSE

Professional Experience

Data Consultant — IBM OCT 2025 — JAN 2026 · REMOTE
San José, Costa Rica

– Led Data Governance workstreams applying Data Mesh principles and RACI-based accountability structures.

Data Enablement Consultant — Hakkoda (an IBM Company) NOV 2023 — NOV 2025 · HYBRID
San José, Costa Rica

MAJOR FINANCIAL CLIENT — ALATION DEPLOYMENT 6 months

– Consulting co-lead for Alation design and production across **2 data domains** (Marketing, Data Governance), ingesting **80+ tables**, curating **250+ columns** and **15 dashboards** for a ~80-user catalog POC.
– Designed the Pre-Curation Runbook and metadata QA framework, adopted as team standard and foundation for forward automation of curation workflows.
– Enabled a ~12-person Data Governance team with stewardship workflows, RACI models, and classification standards across the full catalog lifecycle.
– Reviewed RBAC configured in Snowflake to confirm roles and grants flowed correctly into Alation and were properly documented, supporting fine-grained access control visibility across platforms.
– Authored internal AI Discovery Document on Snowflake Cortex Classification for ML-driven PII identification and sensitivity classification, supporting compliance-oriented masking and anonymization workflows; presented as a company-level POC at the internal AI & Cortex development workshop.

MAJOR FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN CLIENT — ENTERPRISE DG ENABLEMENT 2.5 years

– Led Data Governance workstreams across **5 data domains** (Sales, Supply Chain, Commercial, Data Governance, Warehouse), supporting **80+ curators** and **200+ catalog users**.
– Scaled metadata coverage to **350+ tables**, **1,000+ columns**, and **85 dashboards** through a partially automated curation approach.
– Formalized Business Ownership and SME accountability structures across data domains, enabling sustainable governance at scale for ~3 DG leads, 50 Business Owners, and 80 domain curators.
– Coordinated governance activities between internal teams and client DG organization: structured validation of business metrics, enterprise reports, and data pipelines.
– Curated and validated end-to-end data lineage in Alation, giving catalog users visibility into data origin, transformations, and consumption across domains.

INTERNAL BVO — BUSINESS VALUE OPTIMIZATION

– Developed **~10 reusable governance assets** (recipes, templates, playbooks) consolidated as company-level Data Governance standards, adopted across DG delivery teams.
– Established a standardized validation process applied across **3+ engagements**, accelerating onboarding, curation, and validation cycles.

DEMOS & ENABLEMENT CONTENT — ACROSS ENGAGEMENTS

– Led a team building demos on **AI enablement, Snowflake Cortex and data catalogs**, presented to client and internal audiences.
– Contributed to user-friendly Snowflake and data catalog guides.

ASSOCIATE DATA GOVERNANCE ANALYST II · APR 2023 — NOV 2023
ASSOCIATE DATA GOVERNANCE ANALYST I · OCT 2022 — APR 2023
ASSOCIATE DATA ANALYST · AUG 2022 — OCT 2022
EARLY DATA-ENGINEERING WORK: PIPELINE REVIEW (SQL) · DBT REVIEW · PIPELINE QA

Communication Consultant & Audiovisual Producer — Freelance JAN 2014 — OCT 2021

– Design, production, and post-production of audiovisual materials for businesses, institutions, and NGOs.
– Structured documentation and workflow design, skills foundational to later governance work.

§ 04 · TOOLKIT

MODE
HANDS-ON · STRATEGIC

OUTPUT
FRAMEWORKS · PIPELINES · PLAYBOOKS

Professional Skills

DATA GOVERNANCE & ENABLEMENT	Alation data catalog · multi-platform governance · policy enforcement · data classification · data lineage · curation pipelines · asset certification · metadata QA frameworks · stewardship models · glossary standards · testing strategy (Unit / QA / UAT)
DATA PLATFORMS & ENGINEERING	Databricks Unity Catalog (governed tags, ABAC masks and row filters, privilege matrices incl. compute, lineage, anonymization, assertion testing) · Snowflake · RBAC review & documentation · SQL · Python / pandas · metadata extraction pipelines
AI & AUTOMATION	Snowflake Cortex · ML-driven tagging · metadata enrichment for RAG · AI opportunity mapping · multi-agent system design (CrewAI) · agent-based automation
DOCUMENTATION & PROCESS	Runbooks · playbooks · RACI · testing · job aids · workflow diagrams · stakeholder communication
CREATIVE & CROSS-DISCIPLINARY	Systems design thinking · audiovisual structure modeling · narrative documentation · stakeholder storytelling

§ 05 · CREDENTIALS

RECENT
7 NEW CERTIFICATIONS · MAY–JUN 2026

VENDORS
ALATION · ATLAN · SNOWFLAKE · DATABRICKS · IBM · ANTHROPIC · OXFORD

Certifications

- Alation Professional Implementer & Consultant — ACTIVE
- Atlan Metadata Pro Certified — ACTIVE
- SnowPro Advanced — Data Analyst — ACTIVE
- IBM Data Science Professional Certificate (V2) — ACTIVE
- Sigma Delivery Partner Certified — ACTIVE
- Data Observability & DQ Testing — DataKitchen — ACTIVE
- Data Quality Fundamentals — Monte Carlo — ACTIVE
- AI Governance — Saïd Business School, Oxford — MAY 2026
- Generative AI & LLMs: Architecture and Data Prep — IBM — MAY 2026
- Data Interoperability with Unity Catalog — Databricks — JUN 2026
- Claude Code in Action — Anthropic — MAY 2026
- Building AI Agents with Snowflake — Snowflake — JUN 2026
- Mastering CrewAI for Multi-Agent Systems — MAY 2026
- Governance Fundamentals Accreditation — Databricks — JUN 2026

§ 06 · FOUNDATIONS

DISCIPLINES
COMMUNICATION · SOUND ART

GEO
COSTA RICA · SPAIN

Education

Master's Degree in Sound Art · *University of Barcelona* — SPAIN

Bachelor of Communication Sciences · *University of Costa Rica* — COSTA RICA